might require that the user exists in the corporate LDAP directory. In listing 2.8, you'll add some basic input validation to ensure that usernames are at most 30-characters long, and space names up to 255 characters. You'll also ensure that usernames contain only alphanumeric characters, using a regular expression.

> **PRINCIPLE** Always ***define acceptable inputs rather than unacceptable ones*** when validating untrusted input. An *allow list* describes exactly which inputs are considered valid and rejects anything else. [2] A *blocklist* (or *deny list*) on the other hand tries to describe which inputs are invalid and accepts anything else. Blocklists can lead to security flaws if you fail to anticipate every possible malicious input. Where the range of inputs may be large and complex, such as Unicode text, consider listing general classes of acceptable inputs like "decimal digit" rather than individual input values.

Open the SpaceController.java file in your editor and find the `createSpace` method again. After each variable is extracted from the input JSON, you will add some basic validation. First, you'll ensure that the spaceName is shorter than 255 characters, and then you'll validate the owner username matches the following regular expression:

```
[a-zA-Z][a-zA-Z0-9]{1,29}
```

That is, an uppercase or lowercase letter followed by between 1 and 29 letters or digits. This is a safe basic